When Babur’s foragers returned and after spending two nights in Kohāt, Babur organized a council to deliberate on the next move. They decided to overrun the Afghāns of Bangash and the Bannū neighbourhood following which they were to go back to Kābul, either through Naghr or by the Farmūl road.

In Kohāt appeared Daryā Khān’s son, Yār-i-ḥusain, who had waited on Babur in Kābul earlier. He made a petition to Babur, saying, ‘If royal orders were given me for the Dilazāk the Yūsuf-zāī, and the Gāgīānī, these would not go far from my orders if I called up the Padishah’s swords on the other side of the water of Sind.’ Hearing his petition, Babur was more than delighted, and accordingly, he was allowed to go from Kohāt.

March to Thāl

Babur’s party finally began to march out of Kohāt. They took the Hangū road for Bangash. The very road that connected Kohāt and Hangū through a valley was shut from either side by the mountains. Afghāns of Kohāt and its vicinity were waiting for them to gather at the foothill. When they entered this valley, they raised their war cry with great clamour. Babur’s guide for the expedition, Malik Bū-sa’īd Kamarī, was well-acquainted with the Afghān locations. He informed that further that there was a detached hill on the right, and if the Afghāns came down to it from the foothills, Babur along with his men could surround the Afghāns and take them on effectively. It went as good as it could for Babur. The Afghāns, on reaching the place, did come down. As suggested by Malik Bū-sa’īd Kamarī Babur ordered a party to seize the neck of land between the hill and the mountains, and asked others to move along its sides, so that if attacks were made from all sides, the Afghāns would be doomed. As planned, they could not stand the might of Babur’s trained men. They were butchered mercilessly and a few (around 200) were brought captive along with and a mass of beheaded heads.

Babur talks about a local narrative of what he heard about the Afghāns.